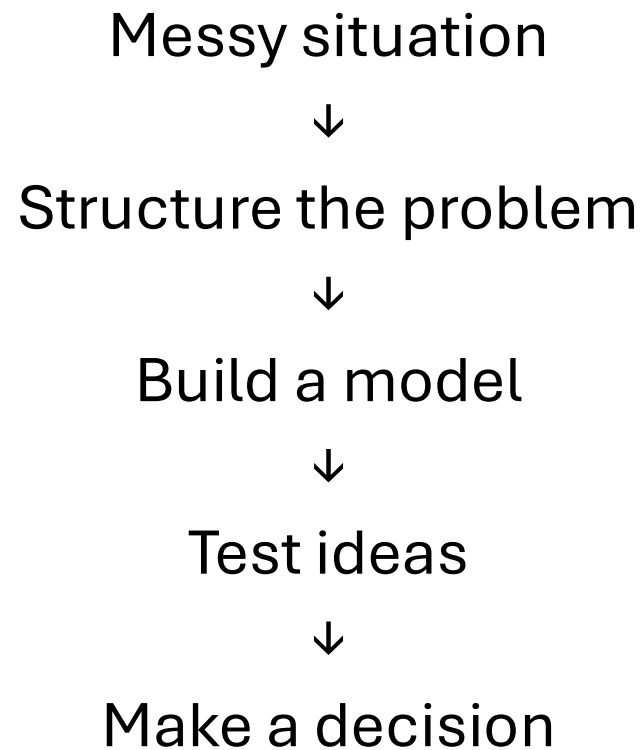


Problem Structuring and Modelling

Emergency Department

messy problem → model → decision

Session Plan



Very brief intro to “Soft OR”

Soft OR

Analytical
Thinking

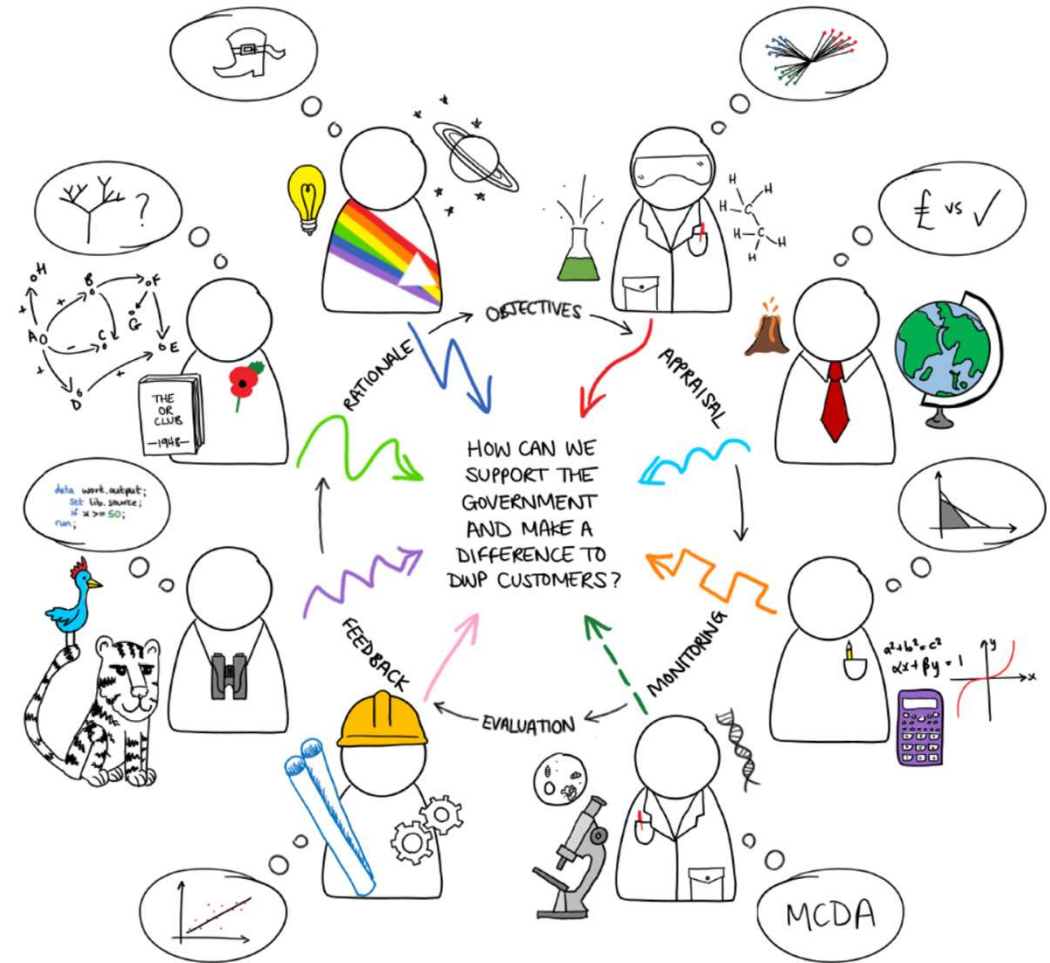
*Further reading:

- Strategic Options Development and Analysis (Eden et al.)
- Soft Systems Methodology (Pidd et al.)

Presentational
skill

Toolkit of
approaches*

Examples – Rich Picture



Working with groups

Planning

- Ownership and stakeholders
- Purpose
- Agenda

Facilitation

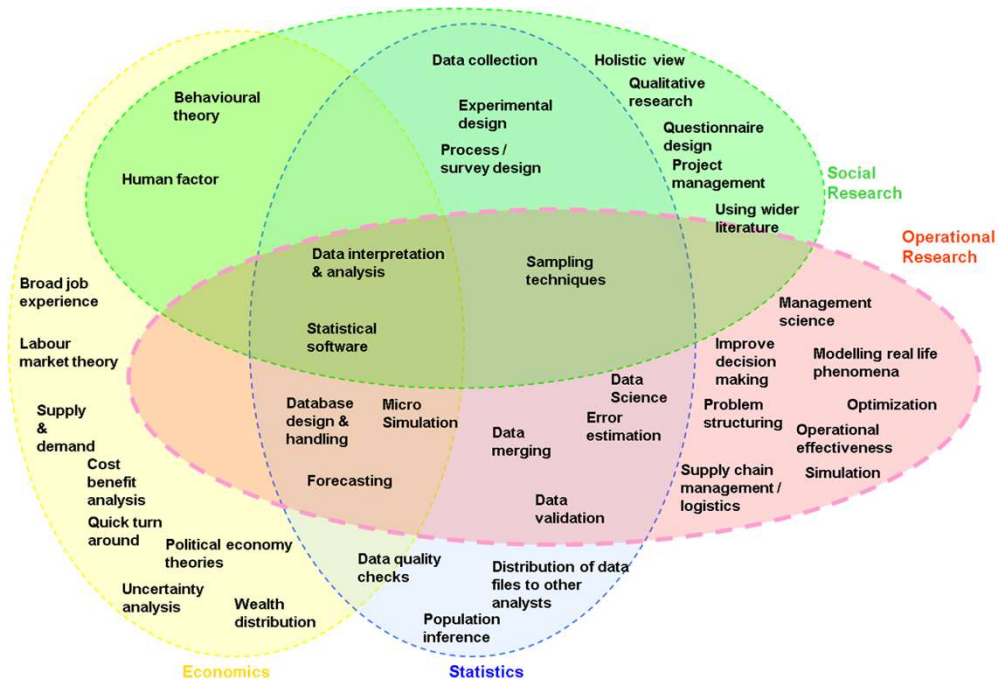
- Goal setting
- Active listening
- Managing input
- ... and behaviour

Follow-up

- Following up
- Writing up
- Monitoring impact



Stuff you already know!



Option	Cost	Impact	Deliverability
Option 1	£	!!!!	Amber
Option 2	££	!!!!!!!!	Green
Option 3	£££	!!!	Red

To structure a problem you must...

Define the problem	Context
	Analytical questions
	Relevant factors
Embrace the complexity	Address the whole problem
	Explore and eliminate ambiguity
	Add a useful structure
Be practical	No “magic wands”
	Consider data/evidence needed and how to obtain it
	What are the risks? Will it work?
Involve people	Problem “owner” always involved and usually others as well
	Give appropriate value to knowledge and opinion
	Be sparing with the call on their time
Generate an outcome	Ensure shared understanding of the issues
	Write it up in an understandable format
	Clearly specify the analysis and data required

Your task today

1. Read and discuss your assigned problem within your group
2. Produce a problem structure for it using suitable methods...

You should consider:

- What are the relevant analytical questions?
- What factors do we need to know about to answer them?
- Are there any relationships between these factors?
- What analysis would you carry out throw light on the problem?
- What data is required and how will you obtain it?
- What are the risks for your approach and how will you mitigate them?

3. Present your proposed approach back to the wider group
4. You will need to manage your time!